



Google Image Search

Google updated the Image Search algorithm, making it difficult to find explicit content by mistake in image results <http://dgit.in/UPKjac>

Anonymous defaces BSNL

Striking BSNL's website, Anonymous demanded withdrawal of the Section 66A of the IT Act, 2000, expressing support for activist Aseem Trivedi <http://dgit.in/UPJXjW>

Build a smut proof PC

A 1984'esque computer environment or a '70s era hippie pc, you decide...

Mithun Mohandas

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

Back in the old days, the internet was something very few had access to, a stark contrast to the current situation where it has penetrated into every aspect of our lives. We've been online for long enough to have come across some really messed up things that young ones are best kept away from. However, maintaining a continuous presence is not only unfeasible but will also lead to trust issues between parents and their children. There are plenty of parental control software that do a great deal but are expensive at the same time, we look at ways in Windows 8 which the same or greater level of protection can be achieved at absolutely no cost.

The goal is to keep the smut out, protect your own files and create a klutz-proof environment for kids or brats, all in the cheapest manner possible. If this is to be realised then the personal computer as a system must be redesigned to incorporate certain measures at a hardware level, unfortunately, that's an expensive prospect. Computers these days can be easily exploited, more so when physical access is guaranteed. What I'd like to say at this point is that instead of following through with these measures, building trust should be a priority. Or else this is going to turn into a game of wits in which the person with more technical know-how trumps the other..

1. Lock that BIOS

The first step is to modify BIOS settings. If your computer was assembled then you should have a pretty hefty BIOS with plenty of options to modify. Here, you need

to apply a BIOS password and then disable boot via USB and optical drives. The only option must be the HDD/SSD that has your OS. This will prevent the smart ones from using a live disk to circumvent your entire setup. Then make a separate windows account for the purpose of filtering.

2. Get a digital nanny

Download and install 'Family Safety' which is part of Windows Live Essentials <http://dgit.in/RKyc20>. Also, having another parental control suite to fall back on would be a good idea. K9 Web Protec-



PicBlock - Filter images with ease

tion is a good choice for this purpose. These suites have a plethora of options to tinker with, this can not only limit the time that the person can access the computer but also the applications & games rated by the ESRB. On top of that you can access activity logs from anywhere on the internet via websites or free apps across all platforms.

3. Browsers

Ensure that only one or two browsers are installed for the target account, or use the app restrictions tab in the Parental control software to limit the target account to only one/two browser(s), we'll go with Firefox and/or Chrome. Install web content filter extensions/add-ons such as FoxFilter and ProCon Latte for Chrome and Firefox, respectively. These are pretty good at blocking web sites with vulgar content since it combs through the contents looking for keywords. One hit and the

web site will be blocked, and can't even be bypassed using proxies. Another option is to use a browser designed specifically for this purpose. Check out KidZui, a free browser made just for toddlers starting out with the internet. <http://dgit.in/UY9oz1>

4. Private browsing

Disable private browsing or incognito in both browsers, otherwise your parental control software won't be able to log the activities, this requires a bit of work meddling with the browser configuration files and the registry. These links should help <http://dgit.in/UPwfNX> | <http://dgit.in/RKk74r>. Once that is accomplished, you'll need to lock down these preferences, for Firefox go here - <http://dgit.in/Ueu4p5>. For Chrome, you'll have to lock modifications to the registry, you can Google for it, or wait for us to cover it in tips and tricks.

5. Block or reroute

If you wish to block certain web sites which you've deemed unsafe, but the filters don't catch them you can manually block them by editing the hosts file located at %SystemRoot%\system32\drivers\etc\hosts and redirecting them to 127.0.0.1 The same can be done to proxy websites to get rid of them altogether, there are plenty of pre-configured lists that are just a google search away.

6. Hide your files

If there are files that you need to keep private, using simple software that just hide are useless against Linux distros and uninstalling said software often just reveals everything that had been hidden. TrueCrypt can create an entire volume which is not only hidden but also encrypted. So even if the hard drive were to be physically removed the attacker would have no access to it. Sure you might lose the data if it got into someone else's hands, but it would still be private. Windows comes with it's own built in encryption feature called Bitlocker but it is only present in Windows 7 Ultimate and Windows 8 Pro.